

Octopus

Octopuses are brainy creatures—they are among the most intelligent of all animals. The giant Pacific octopus can learn to open a jar or find its way through a maze for food. However, they are not very sociable—males and females live alone and hunt a variety of sea creatures, including smaller octopuses.

Chemical attraction

To attract a male, the female releases a chemical. As the male swims toward her, his skin color darkens. The male uses one of his eight arms for mating. About one month later, the male dies.

Strands of eggs

After mating, the female lays up to 100,000 eggs, hanging them in her den like strings of pearls. She protects and cleans the eggs until, seven months later, they hatch. And then she dies.

